AXK Network

CAPSTONE TECHNICAL REPORT · OCTOBER 2026

Verification & Settlement Layer on Stellar

Four Soroban smart contracts and a Frappe v15 application for verified cross-border agricultural trade between Rwanda, the DRC and Uganda.

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LIVE SYSTEM
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DEMO VIDEO
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OFFLINE SIMULATION
axk-open-source-capstone.vercel.app

REPOSITORY
github.com/tejirijesse/axk-open-source-capstone

01 Problem and approach

Cross-border agricultural trade between Rwanda, the DRC and Uganda fails at two points: a buyer cannot verify a lot's quality, custody and container integrity along the corridor, and settlement is slow and hard to trust. This project puts both in one workflow. A cooperative registers a lot, an independent inspector signs it off on-chain, a buyer locks payment in escrow, a carrier records dispatch under a container seal, the port checks the seal, and on delivery the contracts release payment, split it 40/40/20 between members and write an attestation anyone can check through a QR code.

02 Scope: planned versus delivered

Requirement (proposal)	Status	Evidence
Lot registry (FR)	Delivered	`contracts/lot_registry`, 18 tests; id is `sha256(cooperative || lot_ref)`, write-once; only a digest goes on-chain.
Independent inspection (FR)	Delivered, extended	Allow-listed inspectors; a cooperative cannot inspect its own lot; offline capture in ODK added for low-connectivity sites.
Escrow (FR)	Delivered	`contracts/escrow`, 27 tests; asks the registry whether the lot passed; no payee argument; one live escrow per lot.
Logistics, seal, port gate-in (FR)	Delivered, extended	Waybill and port receipt attested; arriving seal compared with the waybill ("Tamper Alert" on mismatch).
Settlement and member split (FR)	Delivered on testnet	`contracts/splitter`, 12 tests; a Stellar test asset stands in for RWF.
Public trace and explorer (FR)	Delivered, extended	`/trace` with QR, no login and no personal data; GS1 EPCIS 2.0 export; `/chain` live event reader.
Security, authentication (NFR)	Delivered	14 contract guarantees, each pinned by a test; hosted site needs a login (one-click demo account per role); 30 transactions per user per hour.
Performance, mobile, low bandwidth (NFR)	Delivered	3 browser engines x 3 screen sizes plus a slow-3G phone: 80/80 page loads (section 05).
Mobile-money payout	Not implemented	Designed only: `docs/design/set-3-mojaloop-payouts.md`; SEP-24 anchor on the roadmap (SET-2).
Pilot with 30 to 50 users	Not yet run	Waiting for ethics approval; questionnaire, consent form and interview guide are ready.

Why the plan changed. The proposal assumed React, Node.js and PostgreSQL. Frappe was used instead because it provides roles, a REST API and a database out of the box and matches AXK's platform, which left time for the contracts. Logistics and port steps were added because a custody gap between inspection and delivery made the trace incomplete. The pilot depends on ethics approval, which is in review.

03 Functionality and architecture

Application (Frappe v15)

MariaDB 10.11, Redis
DocType `AXK Chain Trade`
Role endpoints in `trade_api.py`
Pages `www/trade/*`, `/trace`, `/chain`

Ledger package (`ledger/`)

Canonical records and SHA-256 digests
One client class per contract
Trade workflow state machine
Signs through `stellar-cli`, no shell

Stellar testnet (Soroban)

Lot registry, escrow, splitter, attestation
Rust, `soroban-sdk` 22, `wasm32v1-none`
RWF test token (Stellar Asset Contract)

Each of the six trade steps is one HTTP call from a role screen to a whitelisted function in `trade_api.py`. The function checks the login and role and hands the trade to `TradeWorkflow`, which builds the canonical record, hashes it, calls the contract and stores the transaction hash on the `AXK Chain Trade` document. If the chain call fails, the step fails and nothing is recorded, so the database never claims something the ledger did not accept. Public pages read the stored hashes, re-check them against the contracts, and the browser re-hashes the records itself with WebCrypto.

3.1 Data handling and controls

- **On-chain versus off-chain:** trade documents stay in MariaDB; only their SHA-256 digests, statuses and account addresses go on-chain, so the ledger proves a record without revealing it.
- **Access guard:** `_guard()` allows a signed-in user with the AXK Capstone Demo role (or System Manager). Demo mode only works for direct loopback requests; anything through a proxy is refused. The hosted site runs with demo mode off; its sign-in page offers one demo account per role, which lands on that role's screen and cannot change the shared password, account or sharing.
- **Throttle:** `_throttle()` caps 30 signed transactions per user per hour, keyed by user, so a shared reviewer login cannot spam testnet.
- **Keys:** one Stellar identity per role, held on the server under the service user (directory 700, files 600, outside git). The browser never holds a key.
- **Privacy:** `verify.py` exposes a fixed list of fields with no personal data to the public trace page.

3.2 Three ways to run it

Hosted at capstone.axk.org (Ubuntu 24.04, nginx, supervisor; operation in `docs/handover.md`). **Full stack locally** with `make run-frappe`: every action is a real testnet transaction. **Offline simulation** (`make run`, Python only, also on Vercel): the same screens with locally generated hashes, labelled "Offline simulation, not on-chain" on every page.

3.3 Behaviour with different inputs

Input	System response
Buyer pays for a lot that was not inspected	Contract refuses with `#10 LotNotApproved`; no money moves
Cooperative inspects its own lot	Contract refuses with `#3 NotAnInspector`
Second escrow on a lot already sold	Contract refuses with `#11 LotInEscrow`
Arriving seal differs from the waybill	"Tamper Alert"; nothing attested; lot stays In Transit
Rejection without a reason; quantity 0; steps out of order	Refused before signing, with a plain message
Same ODK submission imported twice; moisture above 40%	Duplicate detected by instance id; out-of-range value refused
Stellar testnet slow or down	"Stellar testnet did not answer in time" after 90 s; nothing saved

The contract refusals above were observed as real errors on testnet and are recorded with transaction links in `docs/deployments.md`. Every lot's history also exports as a GS1 EPCIS 2.0 document validated against the official schema.

04 Testing

Five strategies, chosen by risk: contract unit tests, because money logic cannot be patched after deployment; application unit tests with `stellar-cli` replaced by a fake, so they run with no network; end-to-end lifecycle and failure-mode tests; standards validation; and cross-browser and device runs. Counts are from runs on 31 October 2026.

Suite	Tests	What it checks	Command and result
Smart contracts `contracts/*/src/test.rs`	65	Registry 18, escrow 27, splitter 12, attestation 8: write-once records, allow-listed inspectors, inspection gate, fixed payee, deadline refund, lossless split, typed errors instead of panics.	`make test-contracts` **65 passed**
Ledger object model `scripts/test_ledger.py`	22	Record digests match the original format, error tables, state machine refusals, resumable settlement, seal check, buyer balance check.	`make test-ledger` **22 passed**
Screens and logins `test_custody`, `test_demo_users`	58	Custody Strip fills only from real 64-hex hashes; demo accounts, access blocks and the open-redirect check; lot transaction fields.	`make test-custody test-demo` **58 passed** (5 live-only skipped)
End to end `scripts/test_trade.py`	7	Full lifecycle, inspection rejection, seal tampering, invalid transitions, unknown lot, web routes and trace page.	`make test-python` **7 passed**
EPCIS export `scripts/test_epcis.py`	8	GS1 EPCIS 2.0 structure, official JSON schema, no private fields.	`make test-epcis` **8 passed**
ODK offline `scripts/test_odk.py`	9	Form, importer and ODK Central sync; imports once, skips rejected submissions.	`make test-odk` **8 passed, 1 skipped** (live)
Compatibility `scripts/test_compat.py`	80 loads	8 screens in Chromium, Firefox and WebKit at phone, tablet and desktop sizes, plus a slow phone: status, render, JS errors, sideways overflow.	Playwright **80/80, 0 problems**

Total: 169 automated tests and 80 page loads. A full trade was also run on testnet after each major change (latest AXK-LIVE-CP-20261031-0015, after the screen redesign), with all four records matching the chain.

4.1 Failure paths first

```
#[test] fn a_cooperative_cannot_inspect_its_own_lot()          // Error::NotAnInspector
#[test] fn an_uninspected_lot_cannot_be_funded()              // Error::LotNotApproved
#[test] fn an_unknown_trade_id_is_an_error_not_a_panic()      // escrow and splitter
```

4.2 Improvements made because of test results

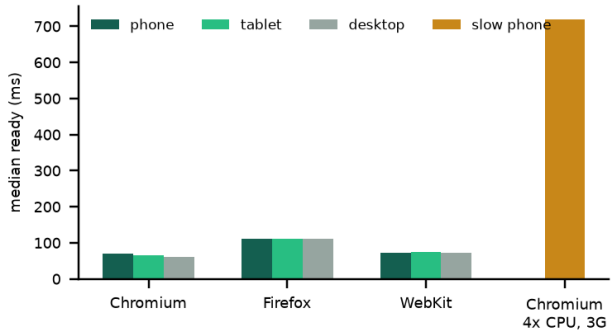
- **Slow phones:** the first page took 57.7 s on the low-end profile because every screen loaded 3.9 MB of framework bundles it never used. A lean page template now ships only each screen's own files (about 2.6 KB of HTML); the slowest low-end load fell to 2.7 s (3.8 s with the redesigned screens' two fonts).
- **Role screens:** Logistics and Port took 66 s to open because balances were read for accounts that hold no token. Only token holders are read now, with a 2-minute cache: 1.4 s.
- **Live explorer:** broke when the Stellar RPC changed its event format; it now reads events over plain JSON-RPC and keeps only the fields it uses.
- **Misleading error:** a buyer short of test RWF was told the lot "has not passed inspection", because the token's insufficient-balance error is also #10. The workflow now checks the balance first and says how much the buyer holds.
- **Integrity:** a failed chain call once left a placeholder hash; a failed transaction now fails the step.
- **Structure:** the blockchain module was one procedural file; it became the ledger package (section 06), verified by 22 unit tests and full testnet trades.

05 Performance and compatibility

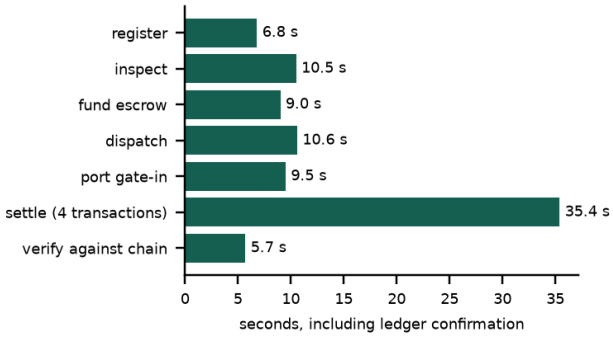
5.1 Browsers and devices (measured)

Host macOS 15, Apple silicon. Browsers: Chromium 156, Firefox 157, WebKit 27.2. "Ready" is the time until the screen's own content has rendered, measured over the 8 screens.

Engine	Size	Profile	Pages OK	Median ready	Slowest	JS errors	Overflow
chromium	phone	normal	8/8	70 ms	140 ms	0	0
chromium	tablet	normal	8/8	66 ms	80 ms	0	0
chromium	desktop	normal	8/8	61 ms	76 ms	0	0
firefox	phone	normal	8/8	111 ms	187 ms	0	0
firefox	tablet	normal	8/8	111 ms	176 ms	0	0
firefox	desktop	normal	8/8	110 ms	168 ms	0	0
webkit	phone	normal	8/8	73 ms	142 ms	0	0
webkit	tablet	normal	8/8	74 ms	89 ms	0	0
webkit	desktop	normal	8/8	72 ms	86 ms	0	0
chromium	phone	4× CPU, slow 3G	8/8	720 ms	3786 ms	0	0



Median ready time per screen, by engine and size.



Seconds per step of one full trade on Stellar testnet.

5.2 Response time and resources

Local full stack, warm cache, median of 20: the role page 38.6 ms, the public trace page with QR 50.7 ms, API calls 3 to 4 ms, EPCIS export 4 ms. One full trade on testnet takes 87.5 s, of which settlement (four transactions) is 35.4 s; almost all of it is network confirmation at 5 to 6 s per ledger, so the signer uses a 90 s timeout and a clear error instead of hanging. The whole stack (web, workers, Redis, MariaDB) uses about 263 MB of memory at rest, so it fits a 2-core, 4 GB server. The main script is 20.1 KB compressed, there is no frontend framework, and the largest contract is 7.4 KB.

5.3 Hosted deployment

capstone.axk.org runs on an Ubuntu 24.04 VM: nginx with Let's Encrypt TLS in front of gunicorn (Frappe), MariaDB 10.11, Redis and supervisor, signing to Stellar testnet. Demo mode is off and every signing endpoint needs a login. Deploy, restart, key locations and the health check are in `docs/handover.md`. The Soroban RPC keeps about 7 days of events, so the pilot plan adds an indexer.

06 Code quality and object-oriented design

The application's blockchain logic lives in `frappe_app/axk_capstone/axk_capstone/ledger/`, a package with no Frappe import: `records.py` (what is hashed), `contracts.py` (how contracts are called) and `workflow.py` (the order of a trade). `chain.py` only wires Frappe's config, cache and clock into it.

Principle	Where it is applied
Encapsulation	`ContractClient` hides how a call is built, signed and decoded; callers write `Escrow.create()` or `LotRegistry.inspect()`. Soroban contracts keep state private; the only way to change a `Lot` is a method that checks the caller.
Abstraction	Abstract base classes `CommandRunner` (how commands run) and `CanonicalRecord` / `AttestedRecord` (what a record must provide).
Inheritance	`LotRegistry`, `Escrow`, `Splitter`, `Attestation`, `Token` extend `ContractClient`; `LotRecord`, `InspectionReport`, `Waybill`, `PortReceipt`, `SettlementRecord` extend the record bases; `AXKChainTrade` extends Frappe's `Document`.
Polymorphism	Each attested record answers `attestation_key()` its own way, so one verification loop covers all of them; each client has its own `ERRORS` table, so `#10` reads "lot not approved" in escrow; `StellarCli` and the test runner are interchangeable.
State machine	`TradeWorkflow` allows only the moves in `TRANSITIONS` and explains refusals from `REFUSALS`; config, clock and checkpoint are injected, so settlement can resume after a failure.
Contracts	Each contract has typed structs and a `#[contracterror]` enum: failures are values, not panics. Escrow depends on the registry only through its client interface.
Readability	Doc comments on every contract entry point, error and storage key; module and endpoint docstrings; test names that read as rules; one `make` command per task.

6.1 Algorithms

Canonical digest (`ledger/records.py`)

```
def canonical(obj):
    return json.dumps(obj, sort_keys=True,
        separators=(",", ":"), ensure_ascii=False)
```

The same record hashes the same in Python, in the browser re-check and in the EPCIS export. Lot ids are `sha256(cooperative || lot_ref)`, so an id cannot be squatted.

Lossless split (`contracts/splitter`)

```
let part = if i as u32 == last { amount - paid }
           else { amount * share.bps / BPS };
paid += part;
```

Integer division truncates; the last share takes what is left, so the parts always add up to the amount paid in.

Also: an inspection-gated escrow (a cross-contract call before any transfer), a hash chain over the trade's records verified against the attestation contract, and deterministic UUIDv5 event ids in the EPCIS export.

07 Limitations and next steps

Keys are held by the server for each role (custodial), and the carrier's and port's attestations are signed by the verifier on their behalf; non-custodial signing (roadmap BUY-3, LOG-4) is the next step before real money. The system runs on testnet only and the contracts are not yet externally audited. The pilot starts after ethics approval, using the questionnaire and interview instruments already prepared. Mobile-money payout (SET-2, SET-3) and Kinyarwanda, French and Swahili translations (I18N-1) are planned. The project is MIT licensed, with `CONTRIBUTING.md`, `SECURITY.md` and a 43-item `ROADMAP.md` for contributors.